Shabbir *Merchant*

DUBAI · UAE
CHAIRMAN · PBC DUBAI 2024–2026

GROUP CHAIRMAN · ENTREPRENEUR · COMMUNITY LEADER

Thirty-seven years, one *arc of light.*

Muhammad Shabbir Merchant is the Group Chairman of **Champion Group** — the UAE's most trusted signage and visual-communication house — and Chairman of the **Pakistan Business Council, Dubai**.

GROUP CHAIRMAN | FOUNDER · CHAMPION NEON (1989) | CHAIRMAN · PBC DUBAI | TRUSTEE · WMO

1989	65K	150+	1,000+	100K+
CHAMPION FOUNDED	SQFT · DIP 2	EMPLOYEES	CLIENTS SERVED	SIGNS DELIVERED

From a Dh 1,500 salary to the UAE's *signage standard*

Early life & heritage

Born December 1958 in Karachi. His father M Y "Yousuf" Merchant was a pioneer of outdoor advertising and hand-blown glass neon in Pakistan — an inheritance that would shape the Champion story in Dubai.

Arrival in the UAE

In 1976, at just 18, he arrived in the UAE at the invitation of his elder brother Hanif Merchant, founder of what is today Emirates Neon Group. His starting salary: Dh 1,500 a month.

Founding Champion Neon

In 1989 he opened an 800-sqft office in Deira as a sole neon-sign manufacturer. Over four decades that workshop grew into Champion Group — Neon, Digital, Prints and Outdoor — on a 65,000 sqft campus in Dubai Investments Park 2.

Community leadership

Elected Chairman of PBC Dubai (2024–2026) with a mandate to modernise UAE–Pakistan trade practices, empower Pakistani start-ups, and expand PBC membership. Also a Trustee of the World Memon Organisation.

> *"Customers are the backbone of any business. You can build with better machines, faster software or cheaper material — but nothing replaces a client who trusts you enough to call you back."*
> — SHABBIR MERCHANT, GULF NEWS SUCCESS STORIES

THE FULL BIOGRAPHY · ONLINE

The Legacy Journey of *Shaikh Shabbir Merchant*

Twelve-milestone timeline · Champion Group · 16 press features · Gulf News documentary · Full

KNOW SHAIKH SHABBIR MERCHANT →

contact